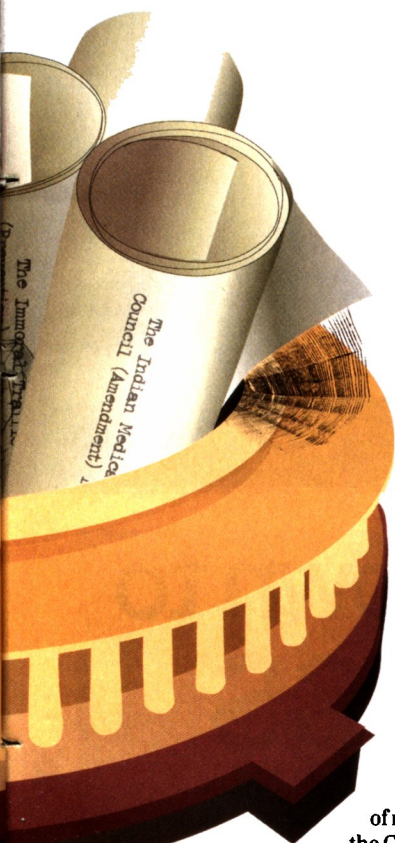




HOUSE ARREST

BILL	OBJECTIVE
The Forward Contracts (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2008 March 13, 2008	Seeks to strengthen the legal and regulatory framework in respect of commodity derivatives market. Yet to be introduced in Rajya Sabha.
The Rehabilitation and Resettlement Bill, 2007 December 6, 2007	Gives statutory backing to the mechanism to deal with displacement relief. Yet to be introduced in Rajya Sabha.
The Land Acquisition (Amendment) Bill, 2007 December 6, 2007	Amends the Land Acquisition Act so as to align its provisions with the National Rehabilitation and Resettlement Policy, 2007. Yet to be introduced in Rajya Sabha.
The Micro Financial Sector (Development and Regulation) Bill, 2007 March 20, 2007	To regulate microfinance organisations and allow these organisations to accept deposits. Yet to be introduced in Rajya Sabha.
The Judges (Inquiry) Bill, 2006 December 19, 2006	Establishes a system for inquiring into charges against judges and for penalties. Yet to be introduced in Rajya Sabha.
The Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Amendment Bill, 2006 May 22, 2006	Eases the provisions for the punishment of prostitutes, increases penalties for trafficking, and introduces punishment for those visiting brothels. Yet to be introduced in Rajya Sabha.
The Factories (Amendment) Bill, 2005 August 16, 2005	Amends the Factories Act, 1948 to enable women to work in factories during the night. Yet to be introduced in Rajya Sabha.
The Insurance Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2008 December 22, 2008	Increases maximum permissible foreign investment in insurance companies to 49 per cent from 26 per cent. Standing Committee report awaited.
The Representation of the People (Second Amendment) Bill, 2008 October 24, 2008	Bans conduct and publication of exit polls during the election period. Standing Committee report awaited.
The Constitution (One Hundred and Eighth Amendment) Bill, 2008 May 6, 2008	Provides reservation for women in Parliament and state assemblies. Standing Committee report awaited.

Source: PRS Legislative Research

of ministers concerned and the Government looked away when trouble brewed. The customer may be king elsewhere, but in December 2006, the Ministry of Women and Child Development declared that it did not apply to the world's oldest profession by bringing amendments to the Immoral Trafficking (Prevention) Amendment Act, especially by adding a clause to punish 'clients' of sex workers. Health workers protested, saying effective HIV/AIDS programming requires laws that empower sex workers, not take away their livelihoods. With pressure mounting, the bill never moved to the Rajya Sabha and Minister Renuka Chowdhury was left holding her baby.

When the UPA and the Left joined hands last year in an attempt to push the Women's Reservation Bill, the threats from allies stopped it mid-way. The Congress went on the backfoot, thinking that the introduction of the bill itself would bring them gains when they hit the streets for the polls. Facing the axe is another key legislation, the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Reservation in Posts and Services) Bill 2008 that seeks job reservation for

scs/sts by stipulating penalties on offices which do not implement them, barring faculty positions and posts qualified as scientific or technical. "This means there will be no entry for the scs and sts in PSUs and the 54 mini-ratnas or those PSUs where the minimum qualification is graduation or postgraduation in science subjects," says D. Raja of the CPI. Even after the Left pulling the plug, the UPA can't push through many reform bills, thanks to the fragile nature of its majority. Worse, they can't encash the rain cheque issued by the BJP as the main opposition party, mauled by the trust vote of July, has sworn to block any bill presented by the UPA.

Tiplers across the country have reason to cheer as the Motor Vehicles (Amendment) Bill 2007 introduced in the Lok Sabha will not travel to the Rajya Sabha, signalling the end of road for it. It provides for on-the-spot suspension of the driving licence of anyone found driving under the influence of alcohol. Welcome to a season of mindless driving and mindless legislation.

For the full list of the bills, click to:
www.indiatoday.in/upabills

